



GOOGLE MAPS

Google Maps has been around for quite a while now. Since its inception it has undergone lot of improvements and it is by far the most powerful mapping system today. That doesn't mean you can't get more out of it. Here are some tips and tricks to make the most of this powerful system.

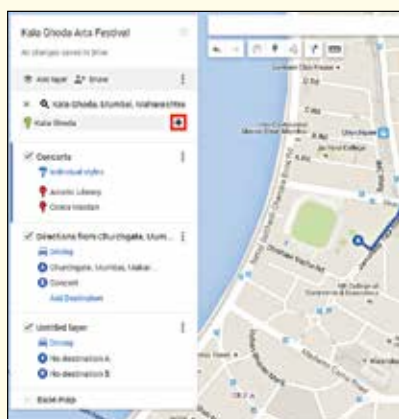
Create a personal map using My Maps

Google lets you create personalised maps to share with your friends and families.

To create your personal map head over to google.com/mymaps log in with your Google account to continue. You'll get two options: Create a map and Open a map. Click on the first option to create a new map. Start by naming your personal map by clicking the "Untitled map" heading at the top left > Enter a name and/or description > Save.

Begin personalising by clicking on "Add layer". Use the search bar to quickly navigate to a point of interest for marking. Below the search bar are the tools that you can use to customise your map. To start with, search for a place that you want to mention in your map, select "Add marker" from the tools and click on your place. Click on the marker to change the colour.

My Maps tools also allow you to draw lines on the map.



Search a place and click on "+" next to it to quickly add a marker.



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Tips & Tricks has its own page numbers, and does not follow the rest of the magazine's page numbers. This is done to ensure that you can cut out and save T&T in a separate folder for later reference.

There is a handy way to draw your personal driving route to denote a shortcut.

Make use of multiple layers

Each layer acts as a group which holds all the markers and drawings. You can assign each layer for similar type of markers. Example: If you want to denote places having concerts add it under the layer "Concerts". Personalise your layer by clicking on "Individual styles" below your layer name. The styles are:

Individual Style - where every marker in the layer can be styled separately

Sequence of color and letters - you get the first point A=red, B=yellow, C=green, D=blue, etc. which is same for every layer.

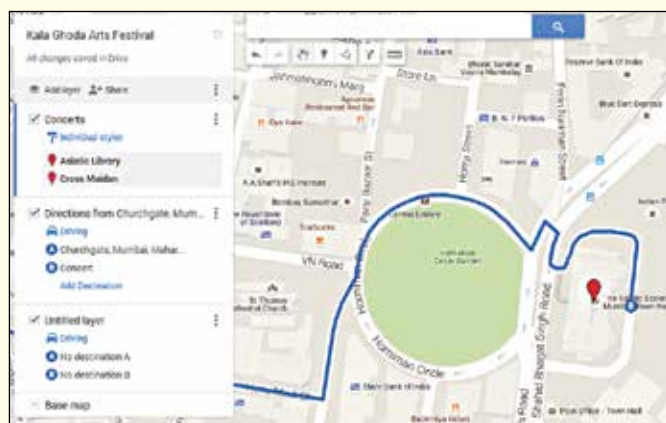
Uniform style - all the markers in one layer are styled similarly

Provide driving direction to your marker

To provide driving directions to the place denoted by your marker, click on your marker > "Directions to here".

Use My Map to denote an event

An event or a festival detailed by a driving map is a boon for many visitors. Now that you've



The driving route is added as a separate layer

learnt how to make a custom map you can use the same to create a map for any event. Make the use of the various layers you are offered. The layers come handy when you are mapping event location for different days. Assign each layer for a day and you can make the map clutter-free and easy to understand.

Pin your address book on My Maps

If you have an address book with an "Address" field in it you can easily pin people on the map.

This gives you a visual representation of their address which otherwise might be difficult to find. For this you need to export your address book as a spreadsheet (XLSX or CSV). Then create a New Map > Import > Select the file from your computer. Once the uploading is completed you'll be asked to choose the field (column) which represents the address in the spreadsheet. That being done Google maps will automatically pinpoint the places in the map.

Easily embed your personal map

You can share your personal map easily by embedding it on your site or in your email. To do that open your personal map and in the left panel where you see your layers hit Share >

Embed on my site > copy the HTML tag provided and paste it where you want.

Get an offline map

Unlike other map services Google doesn't offer their entire database offline, however, it has given you the option to download a particular area for offline viewing. This comes handy when you are travelling and you don't want to be charged roaming data to download maps. To download a map on your phone search for the area you want to download.